# DECLINE OF THE MUGHAL EMPIRE & THE EIGHTEENTH CENTURY

**CHRONOLOGY, 1707-1761 → DECLINE AS A CONVERGING → SUCCESSION AND THE SAYYID → FOUR JAGIRDARI TERMS → THE JAGIRDARI FEEDBACK LOOP → THE INHERITED DECCAN BURDEN**

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◉ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g2 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00

## STAGE 00 CHRONOLOGY, 1707-1761

CHRONOLOGY, 1707-1761 | AURANGZEB DIES; CONTESTED SUCCESSION OPENS THE CORE PERIOD | JAHANDAR FALLS; FARRUKHSIYAR RISES WITH SAYYID SUPPORT | FARRUKHSIYAR DEPOSED; REPEATED ENTHRONEMENTS EXPOSE KINGMAKING | SAYYIDS FALL | NIZAM ESTABLISHES DECCAN AUTONOMY | NADIR SHAH DEFEATS THE MUGHALS AND SACKS DELHI | ABDALI INVASIONS

1707 → Aurangzeb dies; contested succession opens the core period → 1712-13 → Jahandar falls; Farrukhsiyar rises with Sayyid support → 1719 → Farrukhsiyar deposed; repeated enthronements expose kingmaking → 1720 → Sayyids fall → 1724 → Nizam establishes Deccan autonomy

**CHRONOLOGY / PHASE**
- 1707 → Aurangzeb dies; contested succession opens the core period
- 1712-13 → Jahandar falls; Farrukhsiyar rises with Sayyid support
- 1719 → Farrukhsiyar deposed; repeated enthronements expose kingmaking

**MATERIAL / INSTITUTION**
- 1720 → Sayyids fall
- 1724 → Nizam establishes Deccan autonomy
- 1739 → Nadir Shah defeats the Mughals and sacks Delhi

**IMPACT / LIMIT**
- 1748-61 → Abdali invasions
- 14 Jan 1761 → Third Battle of Panipat.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1748-61 → Abdali invasions | 14 Jan 1761 → Third Battle of Panipat.

01

## STAGE 01 DECLINE AS A CONVERGING SYSTEM

DECLINE AS A CONVERGING SYSTEM | SUCCESSION CONFLICT + WIZARAT COMPETITION + NOBLE FACTIONS | JAGIR SCARCITY + JAMA-HASIL GAP + SHORT-TERM EXTRACTION | ZAMINDAR RESISTANCE, PEASANT FLIGHT AND UNEVEN COLLECTION | DECCAN EXHAUSTION, WEAK CONTINGENTS AND FRONTIER SHOCKS | PROVINCIAL GOVERNORS CONVERT OFFICE INTO DURABLE AUTONOMY | NO STRAND ALONE EXPLAINS TIMING, REACH OR CONTINUITY

POLITICAL → succession conflict + wizarat competition + noble factions

FISCAL → jagir scarcity + jama-hasil gap + short-term extraction → AGRARIAN → zamindar resistance, peasant flight and uneven collection → MILITARY → Deccan exhaustion, weak contingents and frontier shocks

**POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY**
- POLITICAL → succession conflict + wizarat competition + noble factions
- FISCAL → jagir scarcity + jama-hasil gap + short-term extraction

**EVIDENCE / MECHANISM**
- AGRARIAN → zamindar resistance, peasant flight and uneven collection
- MILITARY → Deccan exhaustion, weak contingents and frontier shocks

**DEBATE / LEGACY**
- REGIONAL → provincial governors convert office into durable autonomy
- RULE → no strand alone explains timing, reach or continuity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → no strand alone explains timing, reach or continuity.

02

## STAGE 02 SUCCESSION AND THE SAYYID WIZARAT

SUCCESSION AND THE SAYYID WIZARAT | BAHADUR SHAH I | WINS THE 1707 SUCCESSION BUT SETTLES NO FIRM RULE | JAHANDAR SHAH | ZULFIQAR KHAN'S PATRONAGE SHOWS WAZIR-CENTRED LEVERAGE | FARRUKHSIYAR 1713 | THRONE SECURED THROUGH THE SAYYID BROTHERS | THE SAME COALITION DEPOSES AND KILLS HIM

BAHADUR SHAH I → wins the 1707 succession but settles no firm rule → JAHANDAR SHAH → Zulfiqar Khan's patronage shows wazir-centred leverage → FARRUKHSIYAR 1713 → throne secured through the Sayyid Brothers → 1719 → the same coalition deposes and kills him → ABDULLAH / HUSSAIN ALI → office, army and patronage sustain kingmaking

**CHRONOLOGY / PHASE**
- BAHADUR SHAH I → wins the 1707 succession but settles no firm rule
- JAHANDAR SHAH → Zulfiqar Khan's patronage shows wazir-centred leverage

**MATERIAL / INSTITUTION**
- FARRUKHSIYAR 1713 → throne secured through the Sayyid Brothers
- 1719 → the same coalition deposes and kills him

**IMPACT / LIMIT**
- ABDULLAH / HUSSAIN ALI → office, army and patronage sustain kingmaking
- 1720 → rival nobles remove them; factional rule outlives the episode.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 1720 → rival nobles remove them; factional rule outlives the episode.

03

## STAGE 03 FOUR JAGIRDARI TERMS

FOUR JAGIRDARI TERMS | ASSESSED OR ESTIMATED REVENUE CLAIM ON PAPER | REVENUE ACTUALLY REALISED AFTER CONTROL, HARVEST AND COLLECTION | RESERVE POOL AVAILABLE FOR ASSIGNMENT | SHORTAGE OF SUFFICIENTLY PRODUCTIVE AND USABLE JAGIRS | A HIGH JAMA CAN CONCEAL A WEAK HASIL | JAGIR IS A TRANSFERABLE REVENUE ASSIGNMENT, NOT PRIVATE OWNERSHIP.

| POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY | EVIDENCE / MECHANISM | DEBATE / LEGACY |
|---|---|---|
| JAMA → assessed or estimated revenue claim on paper | PAIBAQI → reserve pool available for assignment | MEASUREMENT → a high jama can conceal a weak hasil |
| HASIL → revenue actually realised after control, harvest and collection | BE-JAGIRI → shortage of sufficiently productive and usable jagirs | TRAP → jagir is a transferable revenue assignment, not private ownership. |

**POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY**
- JAMA → assessed or estimated revenue claim on paper
- HASIL → revenue actually realised after control, harvest and collection

**EVIDENCE / MECHANISM**
- PAIBAQI → reserve pool available for assignment
- BE-JAGIRI → shortage of sufficiently productive and usable jagirs

**DEBATE / LEGACY**
- MEASUREMENT → a high jama can conceal a weak hasil
- TRAP → jagir is a transferable revenue assignment, not private ownership.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → jagir is a transferable revenue assignment, not private ownership.

04

## STAGE 04 THE JAGIRDARI FEEDBACK LOOP

THE JAGIRDARI FEEDBACK LOOP | MORE CLAIMANTS | WEAK PAIBAQI | PRESSURE FOR PRODUCTIVE ASSIGNMENTS | SHORT TENURE | POOR JAGIR | ASSIGNEE SEEKS RAPID EXTRACTION | LOCAL PRESSURE

**POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY**
- MORE CLAIMANTS / WEAK PAIBAQI → pressure for productive assignments
- SHORT TENURE / POOR JAGIR → assignee seeks rapid extraction

**EVIDENCE / MECHANISM**
- LOCAL PRESSURE → zamindar resistance, evasion, debt, flight or negotiation
- LOWER HASIL → contingent maintenance and imperial service weaken

**DEBATE / LEGACY**
- MILITARY FAILURE / DISTURBANCE → collection becomes still harder
- RESULT → fiscal, agrarian and political strain reproduces itself.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RESULT → fiscal, agrarian and political strain reproduces itself.

05

## STAGE 05 THE INHERITED DECCAN BURDEN

THE INHERITED DECCAN BURDEN | 1686-87 ANNEXATIONS | MORE TERRITORY, FORTS, ELITES AND PAPER REVENUE | 1687-1707 WAR | SIEGE, TRANSPORT, GARRISON AND REMOUNT COSTS ACCUMULATE | BUFFER REMOVAL | DIRECT CONFLICT WITH DISPERSED MARATHA NETWORKS EXPANDS | DISTURBED DISTRICTS

1686-87 ANNEXATIONS → more territory, forts, elites and paper revenue → 1687-1707 WAR → siege, transport, garrison and remount costs accumulate → BUFFER REMOVAL → direct conflict with dispersed Maratha networks expands → DISTURBED DISTRICTS → assessed jama outruns reliable hasil → POST-1707 INHERITANCE → claimant pressure and military obligations remain

**POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY**
- 1686-87 ANNEXATIONS → more territory, forts, elites and paper revenue
- 1687-1707 WAR → siege, transport, garrison and remount costs accumulate

**EVIDENCE / MECHANISM**
- BUFFER REMOVAL → direct conflict with dispersed Maratha networks expands
- DISTURBED DISTRICTS → assessed jama outruns reliable hasil

**DEBATE / LEGACY**
- POST-1707 INHERITANCE → claimant pressure and military obligations remain
- VERDICT → Deccan war is a legacy mechanism, not the whole decline story.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → Deccan war is a legacy mechanism, not the whole decline story.

06

## STAGE 06 FROM CENTRE TO REGION: A SPECTRUM

FROM CENTRE TO REGION | A SPECTRUM | DIRECT CENTRE | APPOINTMENT, REVENUE ORDER AND MILITARY COMMAND FROM DELHI | NEGOTIATED PROVINCE | GOVERNOR AND LOCAL ELITES BARGAIN WITHIN IMPERIAL FORMS | DE FACTO AUTONOMY | PROVINCIAL RULER CONTROLS REVENUE, ARMY AND SUCCESSION

DIRECT CENTRE → appointment, revenue order and military command from Delhi

NEGOTIATED PROVINCE → governor and local elites bargain within imperial forms → DE FACTO AUTONOMY → provincial ruler controls revenue, army and succession → FORMAL DEFERENCE → title, coin, khutba or confirmation may still invoke emperor

**POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY**
- DIRECT CENTRE → appointment, revenue order and military command from Delhi
- NEGOTIATED PROVINCE → governor and local elites bargain within imperial forms

**EVIDENCE / MECHANISM**
- DE FACTO AUTONOMY → provincial ruler controls revenue, army and succession
- FORMAL DEFERENCE → title, coin, khutba or confirmation may still invoke emperor

**DEBATE / LEGACY**
- LOCAL POWER → zamindars and chiefs can cooperate, resist or become state-builders
- TRAP → autonomy is a process; it is not one simultaneous declaration.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → autonomy is a process; it is not one simultaneous declaration.

07

## STAGE 07 BENGAL, AWADH AND HYDERABAD COMPARED

BENGAL, AWADH AND HYDERABAD COMPARED | MURSHID QULI KHAN STABILISES REVENUE AND LIMITS JAGIR DISRUPTION | SAADAT KHAN BUILDS THROUGH ACCOMMODATION WITH ZAMINDARS AND TALUQDARS | NIZAM-UL-MULK CONVERTS SUBEDARI AND MILITARY POWER AFTER 1724 | REVENUE, ARMY AND PATRONAGE BECOME REGIONALLY CONTROLLED | MUGHAL TITLES AND SYMBOLIC LEGITIMACY OFTEN REMAIN USEFUL | FISCAL SETTLEMENT, LOCAL ALLIANCE AND MILITARY CONVERSION VARY.

| POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY | EVIDENCE / MECHANISM | DEBATE / LEGACY |
|---|---|---|
| BENGAL → Murshid Quli Khan stabilises revenue and limits jagir disruption | HYDERABAD → Nizam-ul-Mulk converts subedari and military power after 1724 | SHARED → Mughal titles and symbolic legitimacy often remain useful |
| AWADH → Saadat Khan builds through accommodation with zamindars and taluqdars | SHARED → revenue, army and patronage become regionally controlled | DIFFERENCE → fiscal settlement, local alliance and military conversion vary. |

**POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY**
- BENGAL → Murshid Quli Khan stabilises revenue and limits jagir disruption
- AWADH → Saadat Khan builds through accommodation with zamindars and taluqdars

**EVIDENCE / MECHANISM**
- HYDERABAD → Nizam-ul-Mulk converts subedari and military power after 1724
- SHARED → revenue, army and patronage become regionally controlled

**DEBATE / LEGACY**
- SHARED → Mughal titles and symbolic legitimacy often remain useful
- DIFFERENCE → fiscal settlement, local alliance and military conversion vary.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DIFFERENCE → fiscal settlement, local alliance and military conversion vary.

08

## STAGE 08 JATS, SIKHS AND MARATHAS: BOUNDED SNAPSHOT

JATS, SIKHS AND MARATHAS | BOUNDED SNAPSHOT | AGRARIAN-ZAMINDARI POWER CONSOLIDATES AROUND BHARATPUR | KHALSA, MISLS AND ARMED COMMUNITY FORMATION RESHAPE PUNJAB POLITICS | CHAUTH CLAIMS AND CONFEDERATE EXPANSION REACH MALWA AND THE | IMPERIAL WEAKENING OPENS SPACE, BUT EACH ROUTE HAS DISTINCT | SHIVAJI'S STATE DETAIL BELONGS TO TOPIC 23 | LATER CONFEDERACY AND COMPANY WARS REQUIRE THEIR PROPER OWNERS.

JATS → agrarian-zamindari power consolidates around Bharatpur

SIKHS → Khalsa, misls and armed community formation reshape Punjab politics → MARATHAS → chauth claims and confederate expansion reach Malwa and the north → COMMON → imperial weakening opens space, but each route has distinct institutions

**POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY**
- JATS → agrarian-zamindari power consolidates around Bharatpur
- SIKHS → Khalsa, misls and armed community formation reshape Punjab politics

**EVIDENCE / MECHANISM**
- MARATHAS → chauth claims and confederate expansion reach Malwa and the north
- COMMON → imperial weakening opens space, but each route has distinct institutions

**DEBATE / LEGACY**
- BOUNDARY → Shivaji's state detail belongs to Topic 23
- BOUNDARY → later confederacy and Company wars require their proper owners.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: BOUNDARY → later confederacy and Company wars require their proper owners.

09

## STAGE 09 NADIR SHAH, ABDALI AND PANIPAT

NADIR SHAH, ABDALI AND PANIPAT | NADIR SHAH 1739 | KARNAL DEFEAT EXPOSES WEAKNESS; DELHI LOSES TREASURE | SEVERE FISCAL AND PRESTIGE SHOCK ACCELERATES AN OLDER CRISIS | ABDALI 1748-61 | REPEATED INVASIONS KEEP THE NORTHWEST UNDER PRESSURE | PANIPAT 1761 | ABDALI COALITION DEFEATS SADASHIVRAO BHAU'S MARATHA FORCE

NADIR SHAH 1739 → Karnal defeat exposes weakness; Delhi loses treasure → EFFECT → severe fiscal and prestige shock accelerates an older crisis → ABDALI 1748-61 → repeated invasions keep the northwest under pressure → PANIPAT 1761 → Abdali coalition defeats Sadashivrao Bhau's Maratha force → LIMIT → Panipat checks northern expansion but does not end Maratha power

**POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY**
- NADIR SHAH 1739 → Karnal defeat exposes weakness; Delhi loses treasure
- EFFECT → severe fiscal and prestige shock accelerates an older crisis

**EVIDENCE / MECHANISM**
- ABDALI 1748-61 → repeated invasions keep the northwest under pressure
- PANIPAT 1761 → Abdali coalition defeats Sadashivrao Bhau's Maratha force

**DEBATE / LEGACY**
- LIMIT → Panipat checks northern expansion but does not end Maratha power
- TRAP → neither 1739 nor 1761 alone makes later British rule inevitable.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → neither 1739 nor 1761 alone makes later British rule inevitable.

10

## STAGE 10 REGIONAL ECONOMIC AND CULTURAL CONTINUITY

REGIONAL ECONOMIC AND CULTURAL CONTINUITY | POLITICAL CENTRE CONTRACTS | PATRONAGE AND RESOURCES SHIFT REGIONALLY | HOUSES SUCH AS JAGAT SETH REMAIN INFLUENTIAL | ROUTES AND PRODUCTION PERSIST UNEVENLY ACROSS REGIONS | COURTS SUPPORT ART, LITERATURE AND ARCHITECTURE | WARFARE, EXTRACTION AND LOCAL LOSSES REMAIN REAL | REGIONAL REORGANISATION, NOT UNIFORM ECONOMIC-CULTURAL COLLAPSE.

POLITICAL CENTRE CONTRACTS → patronage and resources shift regionally

BANKERS / CREDIT → houses such as Jagat Seth remain influential → TRADE / CRAFT → routes and production persist unevenly across regions → AWADH / HYDERABAD / BENGAL → courts support art, literature and architecture

**POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY**
- POLITICAL CENTRE CONTRACTS → patronage and resources shift regionally
- BANKERS / CREDIT → houses such as Jagat Seth remain influential

**EVIDENCE / MECHANISM**
- TRADE / CRAFT → routes and production persist unevenly across regions
- AWADH / HYDERABAD / BENGAL → courts support art, literature and architecture

**DEBATE / LEGACY**
- QUALIFY → warfare, extraction and local losses remain real
- VERDICT → regional reorganisation, not uniform economic-cultural collapse.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT → regional reorganisation, not uniform economic-cultural collapse.

11

## STAGE 11 NON-INEVITABILITY AND FINAL ANSWER SPINE

NON-INEVITABILITY AND FINAL ANSWER SPINE | DECLINE IS DEVOLUTION AND CONVERGING STRAIN, NOT INSTANT DISAPPEARANCE | JAGIRDARI LOOP | REGIONAL AUTONOMY | EXTERNAL SHOCKS | HYDERABAD BY DISTINCT MECHANISM | POLITICAL FRAGMENTATION WITH ECONOMIC-CULTURAL CONTINUITY | RULER-ONLY BLAME, ONE-CAUSE CRISIS AND AUTOMATIC COLONIAL SUCCESSION

OPEN → decline is devolution and converging strain, not instant disappearance → TRACE → succession → jagirdari loop → regional autonomy → external shocks → COMPARE → Bengal / Awadh / Hyderabad by distinct mechanism → BALANCE → political fragmentation with economic-cultural continuity → REJECT → ruler-only blame, one-cause crisis and automatic colonial succession

**POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY**
- OPEN → decline is devolution and converging strain, not instant disappearance
- TRACE → succession → jagirdari loop → regional autonomy → external shocks

**EVIDENCE / MECHANISM**
- COMPARE → Bengal / Awadh / Hyderabad by distinct mechanism
- BALANCE → political fragmentation with economic-cultural continuity

**DEBATE / LEGACY**
- REJECT → ruler-only blame, one-cause crisis and automatic colonial succession
- CLOSE → 1707-61 created opportunities; later outcomes remained contingent.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → 1707-61 created opportunities; later outcomes remained contingent.

E

## EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT | ADVANCED EVIDENCE NOTEBOOK | TWENTY-FOUR SOURCE-TO-ARGUMENT LABS | EVIDENCE AND ANSWER-WRITING DRILLS | DECLINE OF THE MUGHAL EMPIRE & THE EIGHTEENTH CENTURY | 1. SNAPSHOT & CORE IDEA | 2. KEY CLASSIFICATION | 3. STUDY LINKS

**OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH**
- Advanced evidence notebook: twenty-four source-to-argument labs
- Evidence and answer-writing drills
- Decline of the Mughal Empire & the Eighteenth Century — ADVANCED
- Mini-timeline

**ADVANCED DEBATE**
- 1. Snapshot & core idea
- 2. Key classification / data
- 3. Study links
- 4. Must-Know Facts (Prelims)

**LEGACY / NUANCE**
- 5. UPSC Traps
- 6. Current link
- 7. Mains angles
- + Historiography ladder (PYQ-gap)

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels